

ENTERPRISE AI AWARENESS TRAINING SERIES

Prompt Engineering Essentials

Module 4 of 5: Transforming "Vague Requests" into "Production-Ready Results"

TRAINING OVERVIEW

The Difference is the Prompt

Two employees use the same AI. One gets vaguely useful answers; the other saves hours per week. **The differentiator is the instruction.**

"Prompt engineering is simply the skill of giving clear, complete instructions. It is closer to good delegation than to programming."



LEARNING OBJECTIVES



Anatomy

Master the 5 building blocks of professional prompts.



Techniques

Apply role-based, structured, and example-driven patterns.



Refinement

Improve weak outputs through targeted iteration cycles.



Templates

Build reusable prompt skeletons for recurring tasks.



Governance

Avoid mistakes and uphold data safety guidelines.



Efficiency

Achieve higher quality drafts with fewer review cycles.

| THE MENTAL MODEL

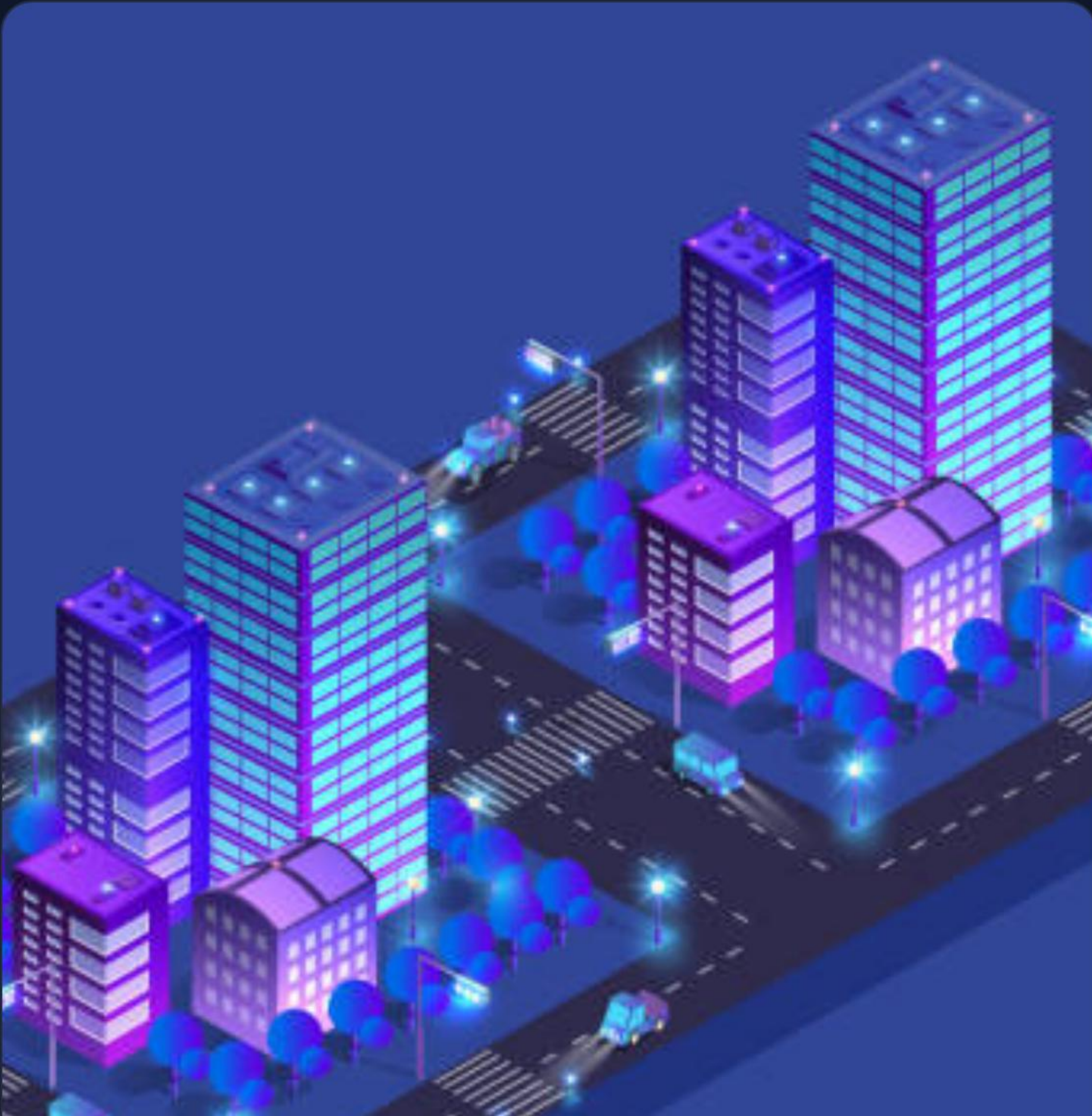
Smart New Colleague

ZERO KNOWLEDGE OF YOUR COMPANY

Think of the AI as a capable, fast, and endlessly patient colleague who started **this morning**.

- **Brilliant General Knowledge:** Knows the world.
- **Zero Context:** Knows nothing of your audience or standards.
- **No Mind-Reading:** Sees only what you put in the prompt.

ANATOMY OF A PROMPT



1. Task

What exactly should it do?

2. Context

Background & situation.

3. Format

Sections, length, layout.

4. Constraints

Rules & guardrails.

| BLOCK 1: THE TASK

Define the Action Clearly

The heart of your prompt. Use strong action verbs to specify the desired work.

AMBIGUOUS

"Write something about the budget."

PRECISE

"Draft a one-paragraph summary of the variances in this budget spreadsheet."

BLOCK 2: CONTEXT

Grounding the AI in Reality

Context provides the background the AI needs to act like your colleague instead of a stranger.



Describe It

"The reader is a long-term client who is unhappy about a missed delivery. We have already refunded them."



Provide It

Paste the email thread, policy section, or meeting notes directly into the prompt. **Refer to it explicitly.**

| FORMAT & CONSTRAINTS

The Structure (Format)

Define what the output should look like.

- "Three sections: Progress, Risks, Decisions."
- "Maximum 300 words."
- "Bullet point list format."

The Guardrails (Constraints)

Establish the rules and tone.

- "Neutral, factual tone."
- "Do not speculate on causes."
- "Use British English spelling."

BLOCK 5: EXAMPLES

Showing vs. Telling

The AI imitates patterns far more accurately than it interprets adjectives like "professional" or "punchy."

"Rewrite the product descriptions below in the SAME style as this approved example: [Paste Example]. Match its sentence length and tone."

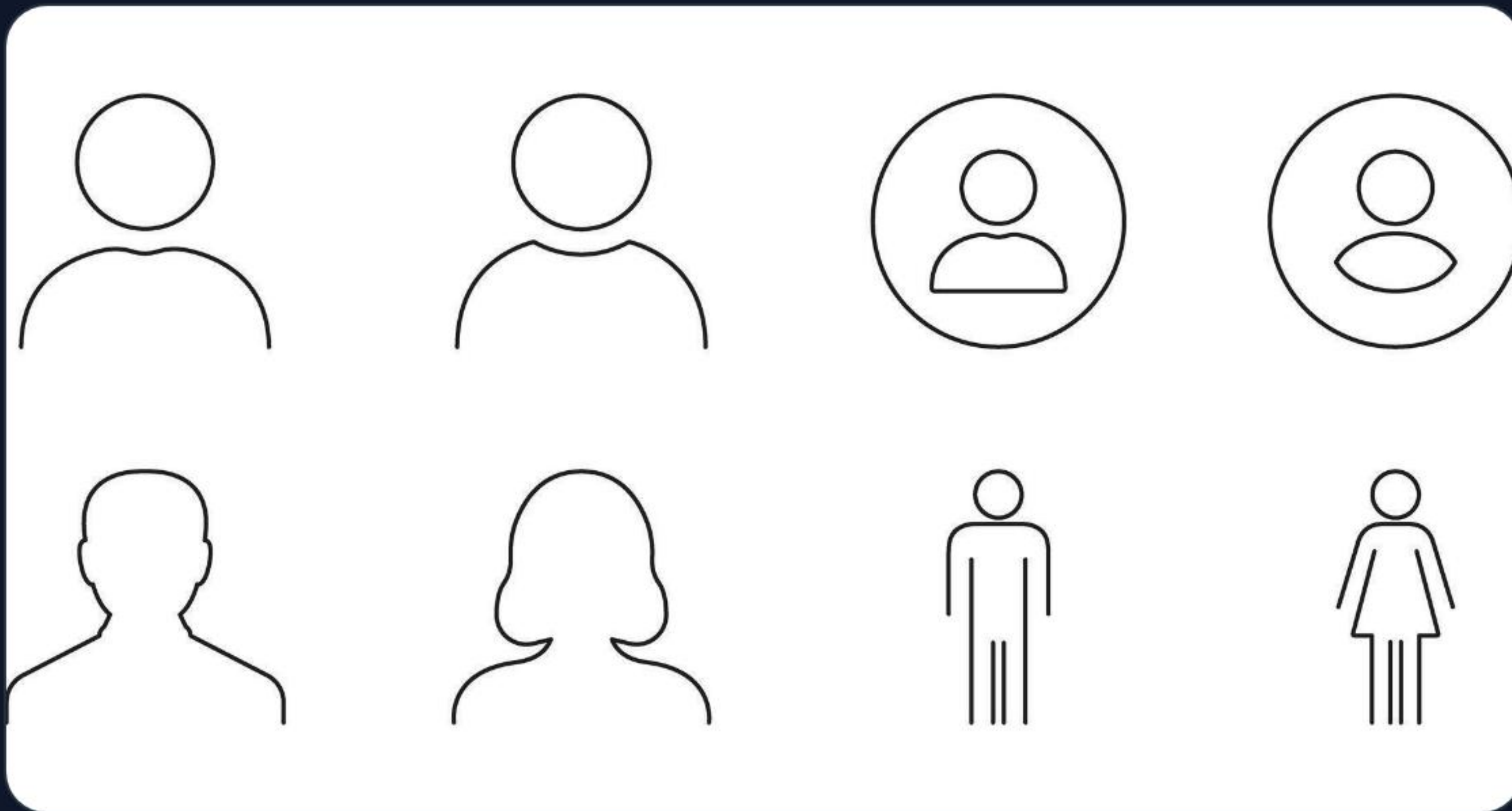
Why it works:

Examples (Few-shot prompting) condition the model's response for the current inference, dramatically reducing style drift.

GOOD VS. BAD PROMPTS

BAD VERSION	WHY IT FAILS	GOOD VERSION
"Ideas for the offsite?"	No team size, budget, or goal.	"Suggest 8 indoor activities for 25 people in Singapore, budget <\$40/pp, goal is bonding."
"Write about our policy."	Missing audience and length.	"Write a 150-word staff announcement for the new hybrid policy. Friendly but clear tone."
"Make this better."	"Better" is undefined.	"Edit this email: cut to half length, keep the apology, remove blame, formal tone."

ROLE-BASED STRATEGY



Assigning a Persona

Assigning a role sharpens style and focus. It "compresses" many instructions into one phrase.

"Act as an HR business partner..."

"You are a skeptical CFO reviewing this..."

"Take the role of a customer-service coach..."

| STRUCTURED PROMPTING

For complex tasks, structure your prompt visually so instructions cannot blur together.

ROLE: Your target persona

TASK: Clear instruction

CONTEXT: Background material

FORMAT: Structural requirements

CONSTRAINTS: Boundaries & Rules

[PASTE SOURCE MATERIAL HERE]

ITERATIVE WORKFLOW



DRAFT 1

The first response is a midpoint, not the end.



EVALUATE

Identify generic filler or tone errors.



REFINE

Apply targeted surgical fixes.



VERIFY

Check facts before circulating.



| SURGICAL REFINEMENT

Instead of giving up, use follow-up prompts to fix specific problems.

PROBLEM	REFINEMENT MOVE
Too Generic	Add the missing context or paste source material.
Wrong Tone	"Make it warmer, like a message from a trusted manager."
Too Long	"Cut to 120 words maximum; keep the next step."
Partly Right	"Keep sections 1 and 3. Rewrite section 2 to focus on risks."

PROMPT TEMPLATES

Scaling Team Skill

Any task performed weekly deserves a template.
Templates turn individual skill into team capability.

TEMPLATE: MINUTES

TASK: Draft minutes from notes below. FORMAT: Decisions, Action items, Questions. CONSTRAINTS: Only notes; mark unknowns [TBC]. NOTES: [Paste]



Shared Library

A simple team prompt library (5-10 proven templates) routinely outperforms ad-hoc prompting by individuals.

WORKPLACE USE CASES

Summarize

5 bullets plus a 1-sentence bottom line. Flag deadlines.

Difficult Emails

Acknowledge, take responsibility, propose solution. Calm tone.

Job Descriptions

Inclusive plain language; avoid gendered or age-coded wording.

Pre-Mortem

Objections from the POV of a skeptical procurement lead.

SOPs

Turn messy notes into numbered steps for a new hire.

Variance

Fact-based commentary for non-financial leadership.

ADVERSARIAL REVIEW

Fresh Perspective

Assign the AI the role of your toughest audience before your toughest audience gets the document.

PROMPT:

"You are the client's procurement lead. List your 10 strongest objections to this proposal. Identify the weakest section."

SAFETY & GOVERNANCE



The Anonymization Rule

Achievement of specificity must never come from dumping confidential or personal data. **Use placeholders.**



The [VERIFY] Flag

Build verification into the prompt: "Mark every claim you cannot support with [VERIFY]."



COMMON MISTAKES

The Mind-Reader Assumption

Asking about "the report" without pasting it. The AI only sees what you provide.

The Kitchen-Sink Prompt

Five unrelated tasks in one message. Split tasks for immediate quality gain.

The Adjective Trap

"Make it engaging and professional" without a reference. Show an example instead.

The Unreviewed Send

Prompts produce **drafts**. Verification remains your responsibility before anything leaves your inbox.

The Path to Mastery

Brief the AI like a capable new colleague: Clear task, real context, specific format, and an example when style matters.

Your Certification Next Steps:

- ✓ Build one 5-block template for your team.
- ✓ Complete the Knowledge Assessment Quiz.
- ✓ Module 5: Advanced Workflows (Coming Next).

IMAGE SOURCES



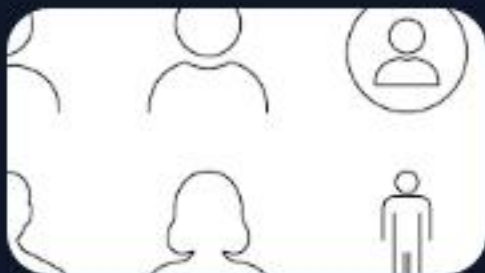
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